MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION

FOURTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE)—MG4DSEENG200—READING MALAYALAM CINEMA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Model Question Paper

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

PART A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 mark

1. In which year was *Manichitrathazhu* released? [U]/[CO1]

A) 1988 B) 1990

C) 1992 D) 1993

2. For which category did *Alorukkam* win the National Film Award? [U]/[CO1]

A) Best Director B) Best Film on Other Social Issues

C) Best Music Director D) Best Actor

3. Name the film in which Fahad Fazil plays the character Arun [U]/[CO1]

A) *Joji* B) *Amen*

C) *Varathan* D) *Diamond Necklace*

4. Which of the following movies of K. G. George came out in 1981? [U]/[CO1]

A) *Mela* B) *Yavanika*

C) *Lekhayude Maranam Oru Flashback* D) *Kathakku Pinnil*

5. How does *Drishyam* relate cinema to the concept of instrumental rationality? [An]/[CO2]

A) It shows cinema as purely technical knowledge

B) It contrasts the moral/symbolic framework

C) It emphasises that cinema has no social role

D) It equates cinema with mathematics

6. What narrative structure does *Swaroopam* employ? [U]/[CO1]

A) Linear chronological narrative B) Cyclical structure with flashbacks

C) Multiple parallel storylines D) Stream of consciousness

7. The demarcation between which all realms operate in the movie *Manichitrathazhu*? [An]/[CO3]

A) Material/Spiritual B) Public/Private

C) World/Home D) All of these

8. Which film is considered the "inaugural" film of Malayalam art cinema in the 1970s? [U]/[CO1]

A) *Neelakkuyil* B) *Chemmeen*

C) *Swayamvaram* D) *Thampu*

9. Which novel does the essay's author mention as having a similar theme with the film *Drishyam*? [An]/[CO2]

A) *The Old Man and the Sea* B) *The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo*

C) *The Devotion of Suspect X* D) *Murder on the Orient Express*

10. During the 1980s, the discourses surrounding the human body in Kerala were influenced primarily by: [U]/[CO1]

A) Technological innovation B) Colonial logic and capitalist structures

C) Traditional rituals and folklore D) Religious teachings

PART B

Short Answer Questions (Answer any **6** questions)

Each question carries **5** marks

1. How does the film *Drishyam* position Georgekutty as a representation of the common man and what are its implications? [An]/[CO3]

2. Discuss how contemporary Malayalam films use the human body to represent social, cultural and psychological realities beyond mere physicality. [An]/[CO2]

3. Explore *Lokah Chapter 1: Chandra* as a "new age superhero storytelling wonder." [An]/[CO3]

4. Write a note on "Madras as the City of Cinema." [U]/[CO1]

5. Discuss the relevance of Eve Sedgwick's "Epistemology of the Closet" in interpreting Priyanka's visibility and secrecy in the film *Aalorukkam.* [An]/[CO3]

6. Is Nagavally or Sreedevi a foil to Ganga? Substantiate. [An]/[CO3]

7. Analyse the role of the National Emergency in shaping Malayalam cinema. [An]/[CO2]

8. What is the significance of the title *Swaroopam* (in relation to the film's exploration of identity and belief? [An]/[CO2]

9. Explore *Perariyathavar* as a cinematic intervention in Dalit representation. [E]/[CO4]

PART C

Essay Questions

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

1. Analyse the representation of state machinery and instrumental rationality in *Drishyam*. [An]/[CO3]

2. Malayalam cinema successfully addresses the tensions between tradition and modernity

that have characterised its history. Discuss. [An]/[CO2]

3. Explain how Fahadh Faasil's characters represent a shift from traditional star bodies to metropolitan, fractured, or polyphonic identities. [E]/[CO4]

4. Write an essay on realism and reflexivity in *Lekhayude Maranam Oru Flashback.* [E]/[CO4]